



TOOLBOX TALK — WEEKLY SAFETY MEETING

Millwork | Carpentry | Interior Finishes | Material Handling

WEEK 42

Date: Supervisor:

Project / Job Name:

TOPIC: Trim & Molding Installation Safety

OVERVIEW:

Crown molding and trim installation combine the hazards of overhead work, ladder use, compound-angle miter saw operation, and pneumatic nailer use in close proximity to finished surfaces. The compound angles required for crown molding demand focused attention to setup and measurement. Rushing trim

TALKING POINTS — Read to Crew:

1. Plan before you cut. For any crown molding run, identify the material sequence, confirm all inside and outside corner angles, cut test pieces, and dry-fit before making any final cuts. The time spent planning and dry-fitting is always less than the time spent replacing incorrectly cut material. It also means you are cutting deliberately rather than reactively, which is far safer.
2. Work at the correct height. Crown molding installation requires reaching to the top of the wall, which on 9-to-10-foot ceilings means working at 7 to 8 feet. Set up a scaffold or work platform at a height that lets you hold the molding in position and drive nails without reaching above your head. Working from a stepladder with a nailer in one hand and molding in the other, on a rung that
3. The miter saw must be operated from a stable, floor-level position — never from a ladder or scaffold platform. If your cut station and your installation area are separated, that is a normal part of the workflow. Walk the piece to the saw, make the cut safely, and carry it back for installation. Never attempt to operate a miter saw from an elevated position to save walking time.
4. Nailer safety during trim installation requires particular attention because the work is close to finished surfaces, and the temptation is to work quickly and with less care. Set nailer depth to the minimum needed to sink the fastener flush — over-driven nails leave large holes and damage the face of the trim. Keep your free hand off the face of the trim in the fastener path and never allow

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS — Ask Your Crew:

- Q1: What is our measurement and dry-fit procedure for crown molding corners on this project?
Q2: Where is our miter saw station set up, and is it at a safe, stable, floor-level location?

KEY SAFETY POINTS:

- Plan and dry-fit all trim before final installation to reduce rushing
- Never operate a miter saw from a ladder or scaffold at any height
- Use a coping saw for inside corners — it creates tighter and better joints
- Secure all trim with proper fasteners — too-long nails can break through
- Work from a stable platform at the appropriate height for all overhead trim

Crew sign-in sheet on page 2 — all 30 crew members sign on the following page.



CREW SIGN-IN SHEET

WEEK 42

By signing, I confirm I attended this toolbox talk and understand the topic discussed.

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